

Block 3 — Theories of Personality II (Allport · Cattell · Eysenck · Big Five)

Allport — Dispositional Theory

Definition (1937): "Dynamic organisation within the individual of psychophysical systems that determine unique adjustment to environment."

8 characteristics of traits (1966, "Traits Revisited"): real, generalised beyond habit, dynamic, empirically established, relatively independent, not moral judgement, idiographic + nomothetic, inconsistent acts don't disprove.

3 types: Cardinal (pervasive; Gandhi), Central (~5–10; building blocks), Secondary (situation-specific).

Common vs Individual traits. Idiographic — individual more important.

Proprium = self. **7 proprieate functions:** Bodily self, Self-identity, Self-esteem, Self-extension, Self-image, Rational coper, Proprieate striving.

Two modes: Opportunistic (reactive, past-oriented, biological) vs Proprieate (proactive, future-oriented, psychological).

Functional autonomy: Adult motives independent of origins. "Means becomes end."

Preservative (repetitious) vs Proprieate (master motivation system).

6 attributes of mature personality: Extended self, Warm interactions (intimacy + compassion), Emotional security, Realistic perception, Self-insight & humour, Unifying philosophy of life.

Cattell — Trait Theory

Inductive method + factor analysis. Personality = pattern that predicts behaviour.

Surface vs Source traits (16 source → 16 PF). Source = better predictors; underlying structure.

16 PF source traits: Warmth, Reasoning, Emotional Stability, Dominance, Liveliness, Rule-Consciousness, Social Boldness, Sensitivity, Vigilance, Abstractness, Privateness, Apprehension, Openness to Change, Self-Reliance, Perfectionism, Tension.

Global traits: (A) Introversion-Extraversion, (B) Openness vs Tough-Mindedness, (C) Self-Controlled vs Unrestrained.

Ergs (10 innate: hunger, sex, gregariousness, etc.) + **Sentiments** (environmental). **SEMs** (socially shaped).

MAVA: 1/3 heredity, 2/3 environment. **Specification Equation:** $R = f(S, P)$.

3 data sources: L-data, Q-data, OT-data. **Syntality** = group traits.

Eysenck — Trait-Type Theory (PEN Model)

4-level hierarchy: Specific responses → Habits → Traits → Superfactors.

3 superfactors (orthogonal, normally distributed):

E (Extraversion): sociable, impulsive vs reserved, introspective.

N (Neuroticism): anxious, moody vs calm, stable.

P (Psychoticism): troublesome, hostile vs empathic, conventional.

Biological basis:

• **E via ARAS** (Ascending Reticular Activating System). Introverts = higher cortical arousal → more sensitive. **Yerkes-Dodson Law** (inverted-U).

• **N via limbic system** (hippocampus, amygdala, septum, hypothalamus). Neurotics = lower thresholds.

• **P via testosterone + MAO** (monoamine oxidase). Low MAO = vulnerability marker.

EPQ (Eysenck Personality Questionnaire) + Lie Scale. JEPQ for children 7–15.

Lemon Drop Test (Corcoran, 1964): introverts secrete 2× saliva.

Psychopathology link: High I + High N → anxiety disorders. High E + High N → psychopathic disorders.

Type Theories (from Block 3, Unit 3)

Ayurvedic doshas: Vata (ectomorph), Pitta (mesomorph), Kapha (endomorph).

Jung/MBTI: E/I, N/S, T/F, J/P → 16 types. Individuation.

Block (1971): Well-adjusted/resilient, Overcontrolling, Undercontrolled.

Big Five / Five-Factor Model

OCEAN: Openness, Conscientiousness, Extraversion, Agreeableness, Neuroticism.

Big Five = taxonomy (Goldberg, lexical, phenotypic, circular, adjectives). **FFM** = theoretical (McCrae & Costa, biosocial, hierarchical, sentences).

5th factor: "Intellect/Imagination" (lexical) vs "Openness to Experience" (questionnaire).

Measurement: NEO-PI-R (240 items, 6 facets, Costa & McCrae 1992). BFI (44 items, John). IPIP (Goldberg, public domain). BFAS (DeYoung, 100 items, 2 aspects each).

FFT (McCrae & Costa, 1996): Basic tendencies (stable, genetic) vs Characteristic adaptations (changeable, environmental).

Theoretical perspectives: Interpersonal (Sullivan/Wiggins), Socioanalytic (Hogan=reputation), Evolutionary (Buss=difference detecting), Social Investment (Roberts).

Characteristics: Dimensions (not types); stable 45 years; heritable. "Psychology of the stranger."

Criticisms: Eysenck insists only 3 (PEN). Block (1995) — factor analysis inadequate. Traits beyond Big Five (impulsive, sensation-seeking).